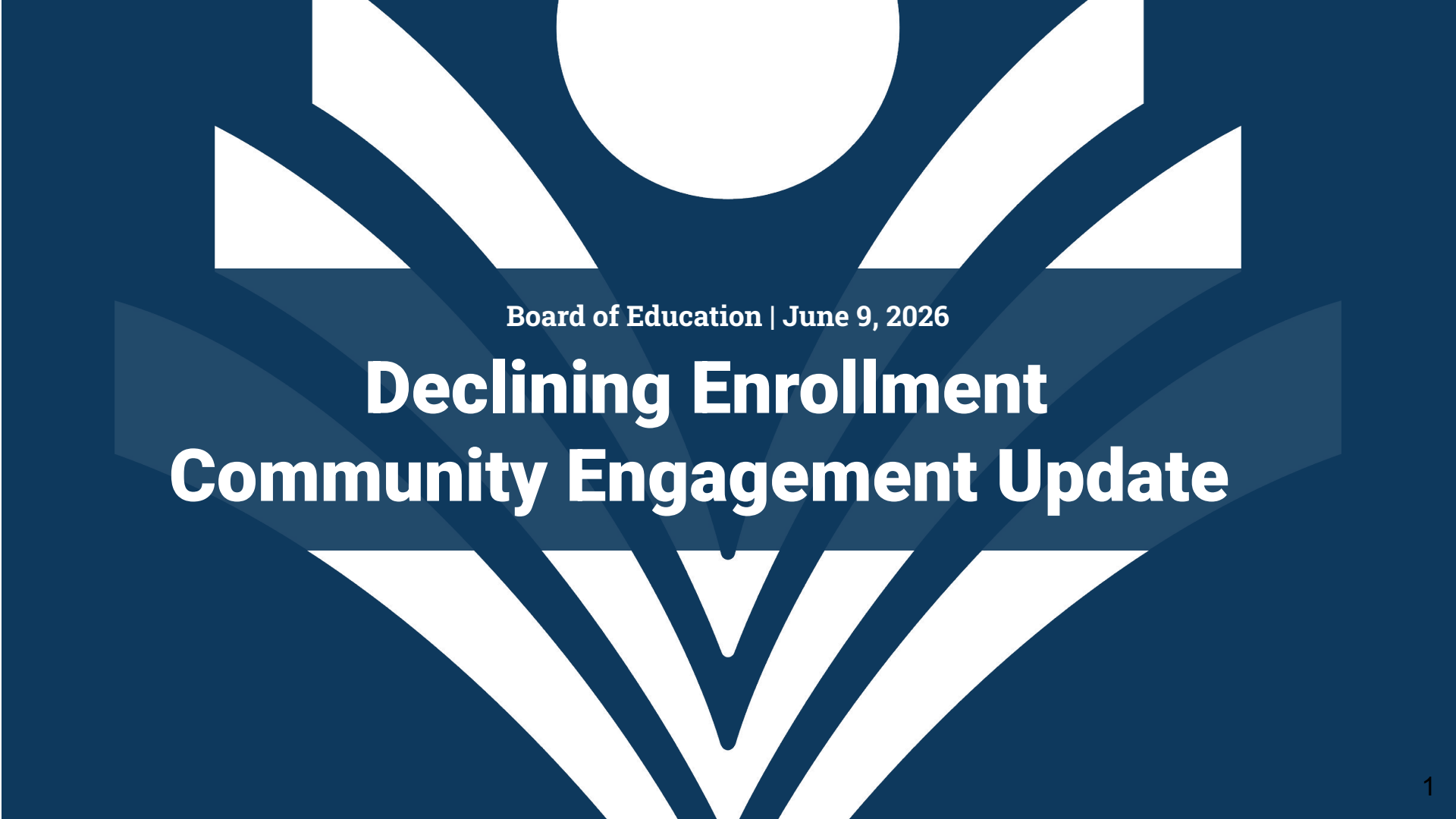




Board of Education | June 9, 2026

Declining Enrollment Community Engagement Update

Background

- Declining number of births (national, state, & local trend), leading to shrinking population under age 10
- Growing population over age 60
- Dwindling housing opportunities due to low inventory, people aging in place
- High cost of living
- More housing opportunities in surrounding districts

THE DENVER POST

BUSINESS > REAL ESTATE • News

Colorado has the four most expensive housing markets in U.S. not on a coast

Denver, Boulder, Fort Collins and now Greeley make the real estate list

Daily Camera

Boulder County report: 80+ population to grow faster than all others

UPDATED: July 6, 2024 at 6:21 p.m.

TIMES-CALL

NEWS > EDUCATION

St. Vrain Valley enrollment falls slightly for third year

PUBLISHED: December 18, 2025 at 4:19 PM MST

THE DENVER POST

January 13, 2026

Colorado public school enrollment sees biggest drop since 2020 as graduation rate continues to improve

GOLDEN TRANSCRIPT

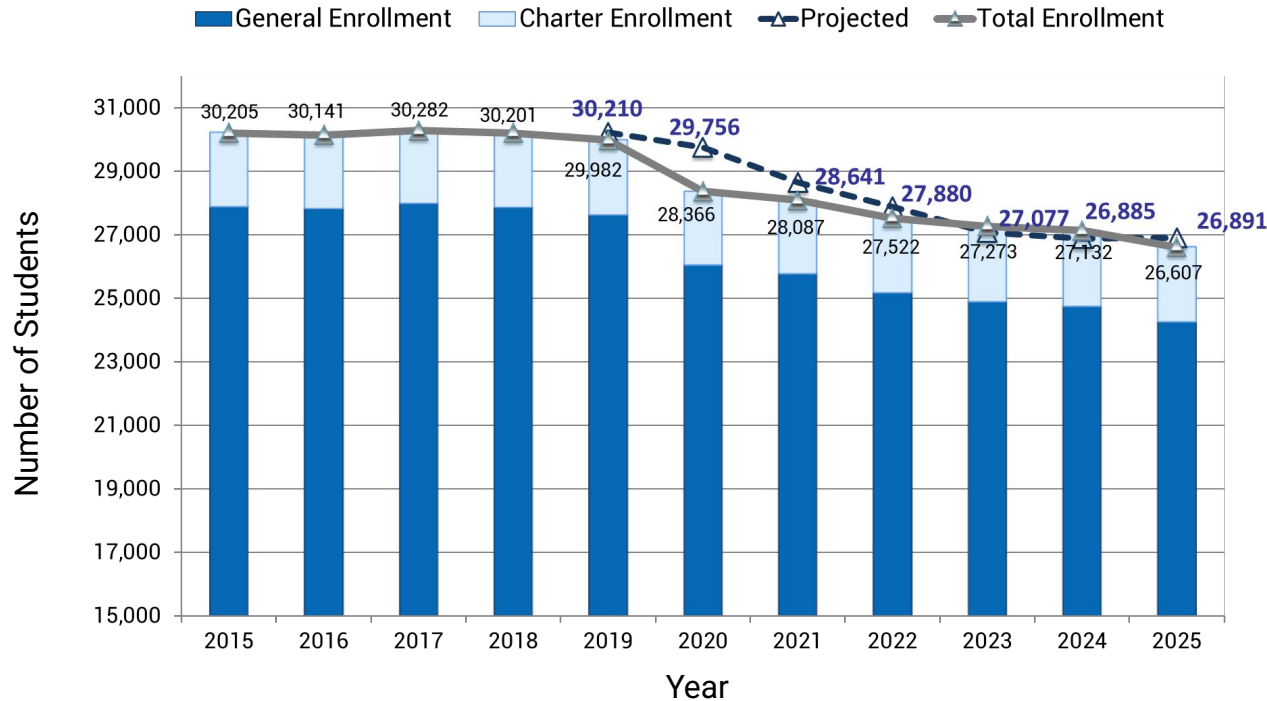
Jeffco enrollment falls to historic low as families move

District records smallest kindergarten class ever; officials point to rising home costs driving young families out

Updated Dec 3, 2025



What Has Happened Over the Past 10 Years

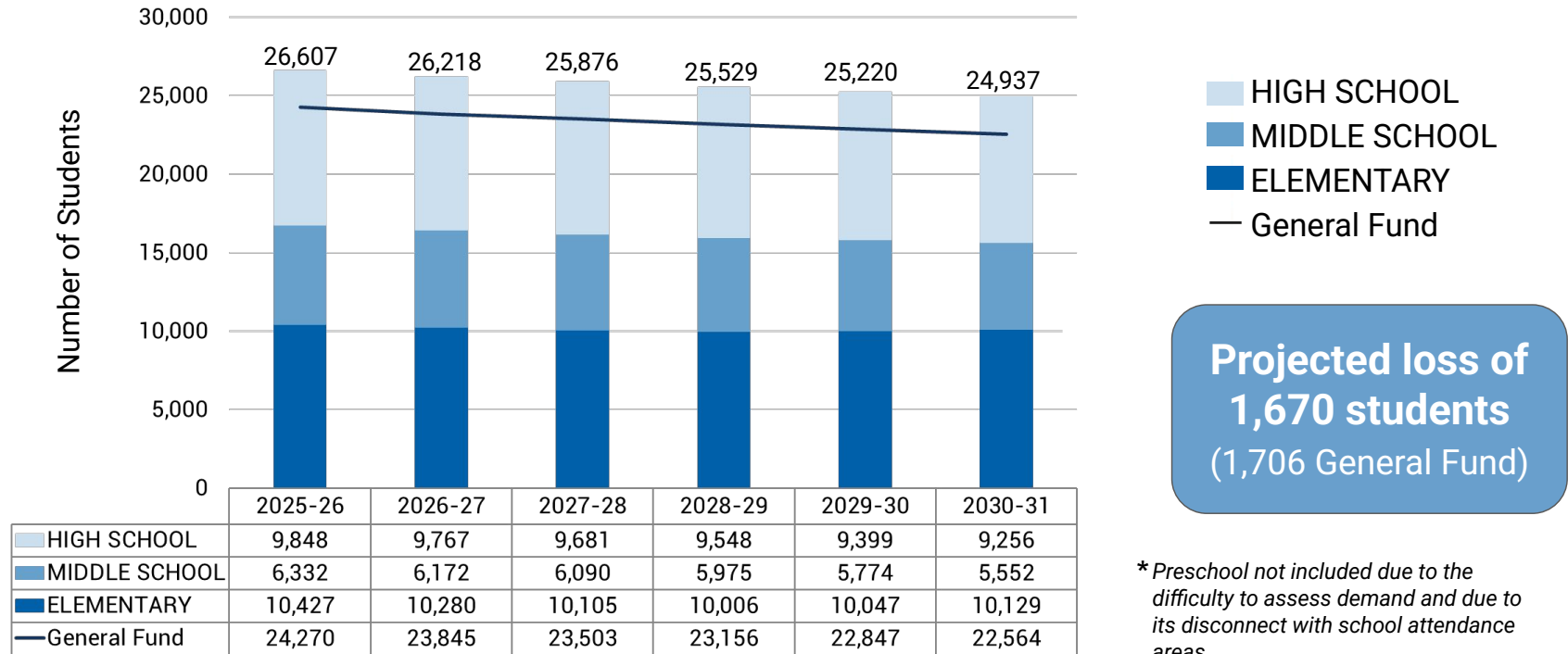


Takeaways

- Decline of 3,675 students since 2017
- Continued overall decline of -1.9%
- Decline steeper than projected (-0.9%)
- Decrease in new, non-English speaking students



Overall Enrollment Projected to Decline



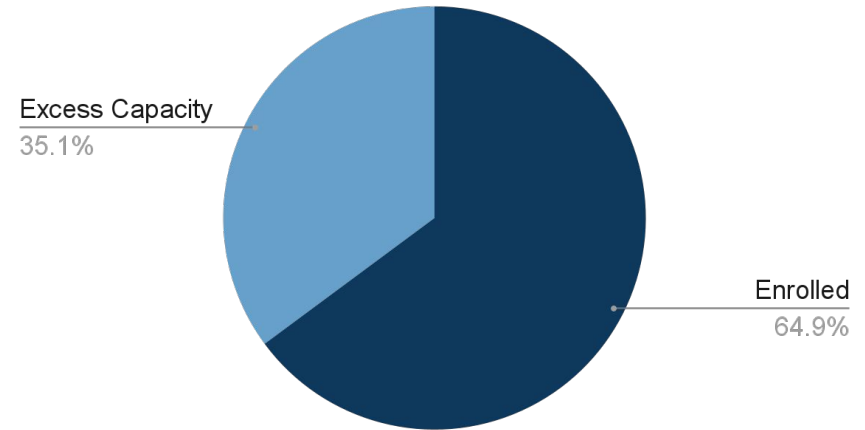
** Preschool not included due to the difficulty to assess demand and due to its disconnect with school attendance areas.*



BVSD Elementary Building Capacity

- BVSD has the capacity to serve 14,543 K-5 students in our non-charter schools.
- We currently serve 9,732 (SY 25-26) K-5 non-charter students.
- The utilization rate is 67% with 4,811 open seats (SY 25-26).
- Projected to go to 9,433, or 65% in 5 years with 5,110 open seats.

BVSD Projected Utilization 2030-31



5-year Elementary Enrollment Projections

ELEMENTARY ENROLLMENT TRENDS

- **Boulder**

- Continued enrollment declines

- 8 of 14 (57%) schools projected to be at or below 2 classes per grade level with a regional building utilization of 59%. Two additional schools are projected to be near the threshold for only two classes per grade level.

- **Louisville-Superior**

- Continued enrollment declines

- 3 of 6 (50%) schools projected to be at or below 2 classes per grade level with a regional building utilization of 64%

- **Lafayette-Erie**

- Slow enrollment growth

- One school projected to be at or below 2 classes per grade level with a regional building utilization of 82%

- **Broomfield**

- Continued enrollment declines

- 2 of 4 (50%) schools projected to be at or below 2 classes per grade level with a regional building utilization of 74%

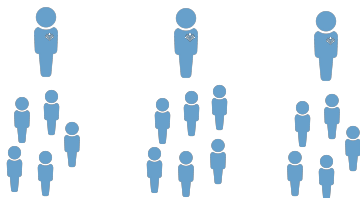


Elementary School Programmatic Impacts

Three Round (~450)

(3 classes per grade level)

Grade 1

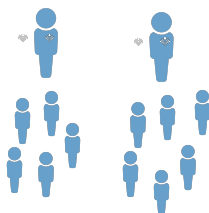


- ABC Specials rotation
- Instrumental music
- Ideal for programming
- Dedicated counselor, Specials teachers, Teacher Librarians, & Special Education teachers

Two Round (~300)

(2 classes per grade level)

Grade 1



- Traveling teachers
- Scheduling complexity & limitations
- Programming limitations

One Round (~150)

(1 class per grade level)

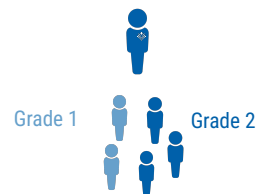
Grade 1



- Limited teacher collaboration
- Lack of flexibility to shift students
- More programming limitations

Multi Grade

(<1 class per grade level)



- Yearly change
- Complex planning for teachers



BVSD Response To Date

2021-22

- Created Long Range Advisory Committee (April 2022)

2022-23

- LRAC metrics and recommendations (June 2023)

2023-24

- Parent enrollment survey (Sept. 2023)
- Place to Be Showcase (Oct. 2023)
- Annual Trend Report (Feb. 2024)
- Initiated Heatherwood Community Engagement (Mar. 2024)
- Updated enrollment-related policies

2024-25

- Approved Heatherwood focus program (Sept. 2024)
- New enrollment dashboard (Sept. 2024)
- New commuter Choice Enrollment preference (Oct. 2024)
- Place to Be Showcase (Oct. 2024)

2025-26

- Adopted new attendance boundaries (Sept. 2025)
- Long range planning worksession (Oct. 2025)
- Place to Be Showcase (Oct. 2025)
- Launch community engagement (Jan. 2026)



Guiding Principles

- Equity and access should be at the heart of every recommendation or decision in the enrollment context. Consideration should be given regarding impacts to historically underserved populations. In BVSD, equity includes but is not limited to: removing institutional barriers, embracing and respecting diversity, enhancing inclusion, intentional support for students, staff, family and community, culturally responsive teaching, learning, and leading.
- Data should play a significant role in the decision-making process.
- Decisions should aim to maximize efficient use of resources for all students.
- It should be understood that change is hard, and communities will need to be supported through any transition.
- Municipalities should be included in conversations about closing or consolidating schools.
- The facility condition and the cost to modernize an existing school to meet educational specifications should be taken into consideration.
- District-wide responses and optimization of resources should also be explored when appropriate.



Important Considerations

TRANSPORTATION

Actions such as consolidating schools or placing a new program at a school will create different student transportation needs. Students may need to travel farther, which may make them eligible for school bus transportation or require a car trip rather than traveling by foot or bike. Additional vehicles on the road may create more emissions and congestion. Additionally, student commute time may increase. The ongoing bus driver shortage may be a limiting factor.

FUTURE CAPITAL CONSTRUCTION/MAINTENANCE COSTS

School buildings will continue to age and will require major, high cost major maintenance at regular intervals. These costs should be a consideration when evaluating continuing to operate a building. Additionally, the costs associated with renovating a building for additional enrollment or a change of program should also be considered.

ENVIRONMENTAL SUSTAINABILITY

BVSD has made an organizational commitment to sustainability. Proposed actions should be evaluated in terms of impact to sustainability. Factors such as the cost and consumption of resources to operate and maintain underutilized buildings should be considered. Conversely, some proposed actions may adversely affect sustainability such as increasing vehicular miles traveled.



Defining Goals

Future decisions should:

- Maintain and improve learning outcomes for all students
- Distribute students so all schools have the right level of students/resources to maintain high-quality learning experiences
- Stabilize overall enrollment by retaining current students and attracting new students to the district
- Maximize all efficiencies to address ongoing fiscal challenges

School Adjustment Options

~~Allow schools to stay “small”~~

Introduce or expand focus programs

Grade reconfiguration, e.g. K-2 & 3-5 or convert K-8s to elementary and middle

Relocate focus programs

Consolidate two or more schools into one building (existing or new)

Close one or more schools and distribute students to multiple schools





Community Engagement

Community Engagement To Date

30 Elementary teacher and staff roundtables

4 Meetings with elementary principals in regional groups

7 **Community Engagement Sessions**
New Vista High, Monarch High, Broomfield High, Boulder High, BVSD Education Center, Spanish only (1)

Presentations to city councils

4 Superior, Louisville, Boulder, Broomfield

14 **Presentations to advisory groups**

- Teachers Advisory Council
- Principals Advisory Council
- District Accountability Committee
- District Parent Council
- Community Bond Oversight Committee
- Community Leadership Academy
- Long Range Advisory Committee
- Latino Parent Council

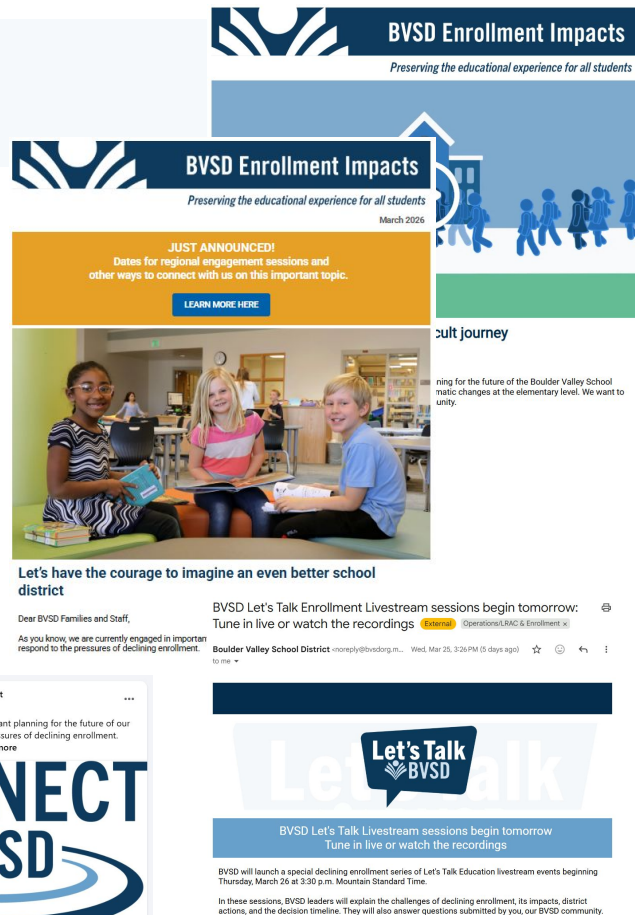
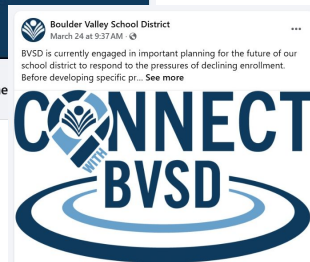
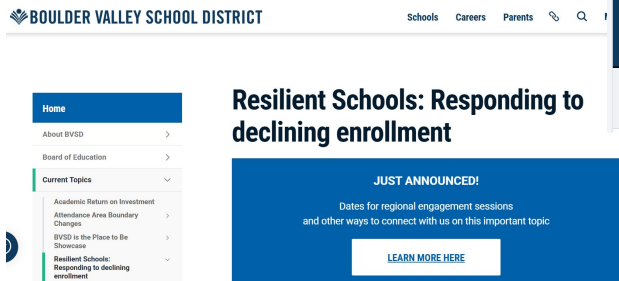


BOULDER VALLEY
SCHOOL DISTRICT



Communications Coverage

- Enrollment Impacts Newsletter (monthly)
- Video: What is declining enrollment and why does it matter?
- Website (ongoing)
- Social (ongoing)
- Direct emails (as needed)
- News media



Tune in to the conversations

**Viewable
online:**



BOULDER VALLEY SCHOOL DISTRICT



EPISODE **1** **The challenge of declining enrollment**
March 26



EPISODE **2** **The impact on our schools**
April 2



EPISODE **3** **The options and next steps**
April 9



Resilient Schools: Responding to declining enrollment

Community Engagement Sessions



Oportunidades de participación



Opportunities for Engagement

Options brought forward to the Board in August and subsequent decision-making will be contingent on our community thoughtfully engaging with us.

JANUARY - FEBRUARY

- Teacher Roundtable Feedback

MARCH

- Let's Talk Livestream Questionnaire

APRIL

- Community Engagement Sessions

MAY

- Parent, staff and community surveys
- Community Engagement Session in Spanish



A blue-tinted photograph of a group of students sitting on bleachers in a school setting, many of them holding and reading books. The image is overlaid with a semi-transparent blue filter and a large, light-blue geometric shape consisting of several overlapping triangles and polygons. The word "Data" is written in white, bold, sans-serif font on the left side of the image.

Data

Data Sources



Teacher Roundtable Discussions

teachers & staff

328 responses



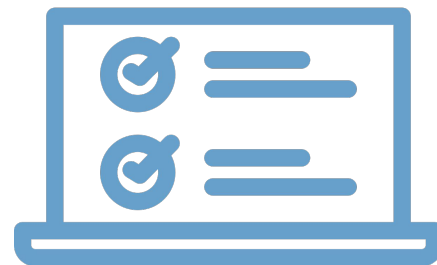
Community Engagement Sessions

parents, staff, community

708 responses

Sustainable Shifts Feedback: 568

Follow-up Survey: 140



Resilient Schools Survey

parents, staff, community

5244 responses



Data Sources Summary

Source	Total Sample	Response Count	Response Rate
Elementary & K8 Teacher Roundtables (30 sessions)	NA	328	NA
Community Engagement Feedback Packets (7 sessions)	643	568	88%
Community Engagement Follow-Up Survey	583	140	24%
Resilient Schools Survey			
Staff	6110	1700	28%
Parent/Guardian	32966	2936	9%
Community	NA	608	NA
Survey Total		5244	

Total Response
Count:

6,280



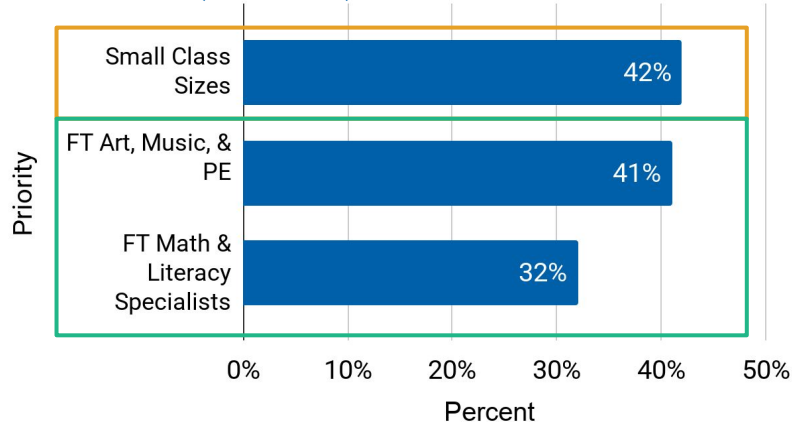
Top Priorities

RESILIENT SCHOOLS COMMUNITY SURVEY

Items selected as most important (Maxdiff) (N = 5244)

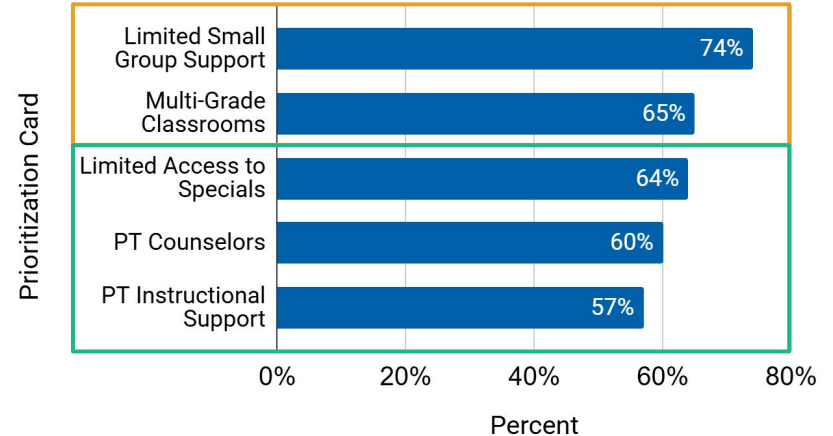
- Small Class Sizes
- Equitable Funding
- Neighborhood Proximity
- Advanced Academics
- FT Art, Music, & PE
- FT Math & Literacy Specialists

Must-Haves (N = 5244)



COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT SESSIONS

Experience Cards (N= 106)



ROUNDTABLES (N=30)

- Small Class Sizes (90%)
- PT Staff Challenges (66%)

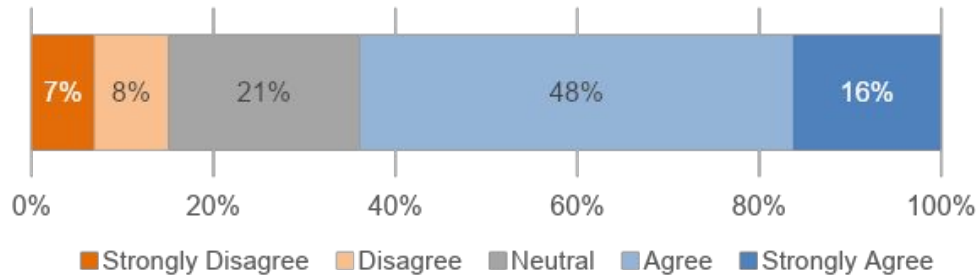


Top Priorities

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT SESSIONS

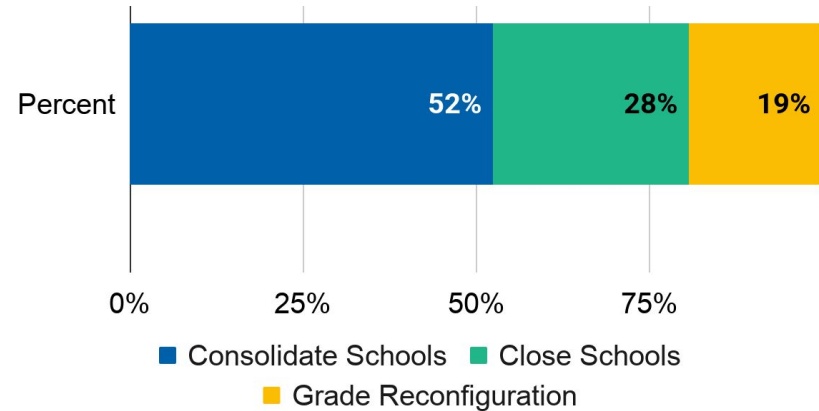
Top Shift Rating: Consolidate Schools (N= 503)

- I believe this action is a move in the right direction to solve the challenges of under-enrolled schools.



ROUNDTABLES

Top Shift Rating: Consolidate Schools (N= 252)



Key Themes

1. Class Size & Instructional Complexity
2. Comprehensive Full-Time Staff
 - a. Special Education
 - b. Whole Child Support & Staffing Stability
3. Equitable Funding
4. Walkability & Neighborhood Schools
5. Varied School Models



Key Theme: Class Size & Instructional Complexity

- **Top Priority:** Small class sizes
- **Redefining Capacity:** Class size accounting for increasing student complexity—not just the number of desks in the room.



Key Theme: Comprehensive Full-Time Staff

- **Special Education**
 - **Sustainable Caseloads:** Staffing must move from "stretched thin" to fully supported.



Key Theme: Comprehensive Full-Time Staff

- **Whole Child Support & Staffing Stability**
 - **Instructional Stability:** Teachers need a consistent, daily support team to meet increasing student needs.
 - **Service Gaps:** Relying on shared or part-time roles compromises the continuity of student experiences.



Key Theme: Equitable Funding

- **Equity-Based Funding:** Differentiated funding is needed to ensure resources follow student needs.
- **"Cut from the Top":** Central administration reductions must precede any cuts to school-level staff or buildings.
- **Asset Preservation:** Buildings are viewed as long-term assets; stakeholders warn against selling property.



Key Theme: Walkability & Neighborhood Schools

- **Cultural Loss:** Shifting from biking and walking to driving is seen as a loss to community identity.
- **Civic Commitment:** Walkable access is defended as a core value for pedestrian safety and environmental health.



Key Theme: Varied School Models

- **Educational Diversity:** Varied models are essential to meet unique learning styles and student interests.
- **Competitive Advantage:** Focus programs serve as a "pull factor" for family recruitment and retention.



Nuances by Region

- **Broomfield Boundaries:** Stakeholders at Birch, Kohl, and Aspen Creek advocated to redraw attendance lines.
- **The K-8 Divide:** Louisville/Superior stakeholders are nearly evenly split between structural separation and model preservation.



Nuances by Role

- **Families:**
 - **Logistics:** Grade splits are viewed as structural deal breakers.
 - **Advanced Opportunities:** Gifted & Talented programs are a point of tension.
- **Staff:**
 - **Collaboration:** High value placed on collaborative teams and planning time.



Nuances for Spanish-Only Session

- **Core Value:** Prioritize cultural preservation and bilingual access above all else.
- **Transportation:** Increased travel is viewed as a barrier to access, not just a logistical hurdle.
- **Student Disruption:** School closures are feared as disruptive events that could diminish student attitudes about school.



Last Additional Thoughts

- **Educator Well-being:** Supportive working conditions.
- **Transparency:** A proposal that reflects engagement process input and clear data will be essential for community support.
- **Competing Values:** The community feedback includes competing values, and tradeoffs will be necessary.

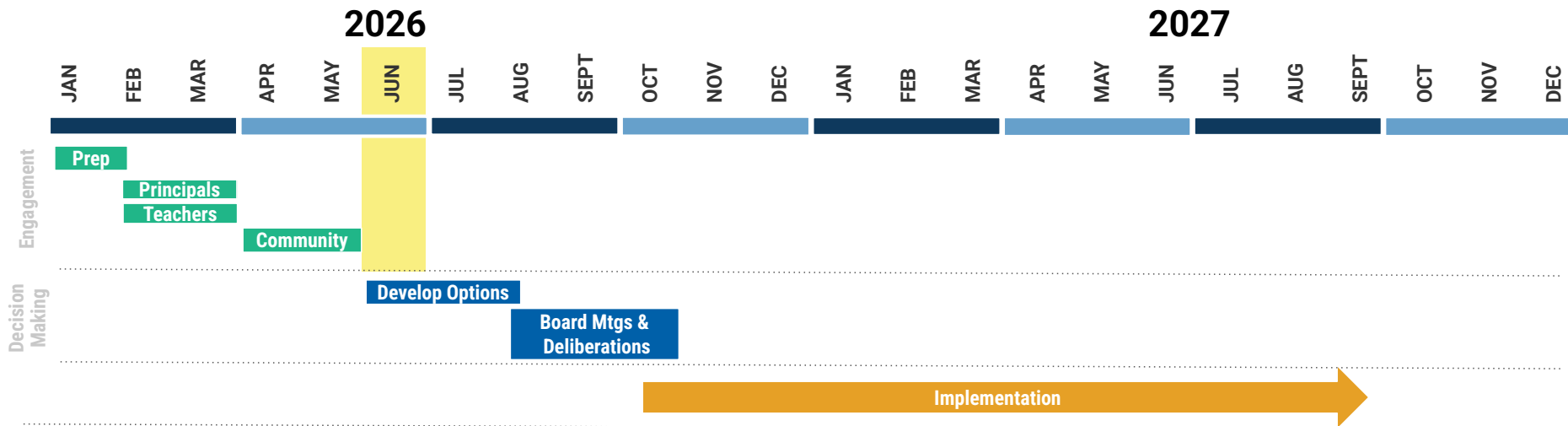




Board Discussion



Next Steps



Engagement

Jan - Mar '26 - Preparation

- Engage principals and teachers
- Orientation sessions with Board and Superintendent advisory committees
- Begin to engage with municipalities

Mar - May '26 Build understanding of the problem & collect input

- Regional community group meetings and stakeholder specific sessions
- Surveys

Decision-Making

Jun - Aug '26 - Develop school adjustment options

- Present summary of community engagement to Board (June)
- Staff to develop facility planning options (June-August)

Aug '26 - Present school adjustment options to the Board

- Board's opportunity to discuss options
- Opportunity for community input during public comment

Sep '26 - Present final plan for study to the Board

This will include updated attendance boundaries, open enrollment preferences, analysis of facility improvements required (if any), etc.

- Opportunity for community input during public comment

Oct '26 - Present final plan for action to the Board

- Necessary for BVSD open enrollment timeline Nov. 1 - early January 2027

Implementation

Nov '26 - Aug '27 -Student / Staff Transition Planning & Support

- Enrollment specialists to provide direct support to impacted families throughout the enrollment process
- Support impacted staff and families with transition
- Plan for implementation
- Facility real estate process if needed



Data Appendix

Session Overview and Attendance

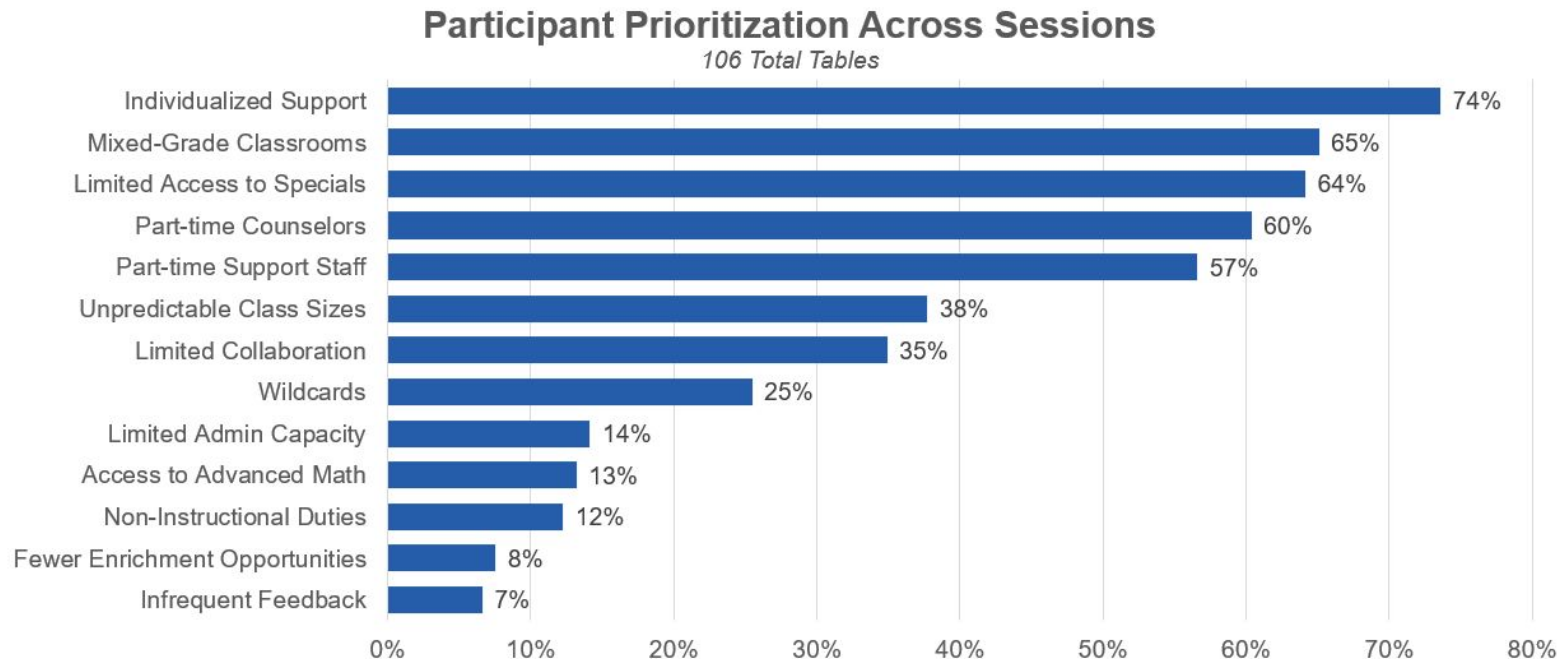
Session Date & Location	Total Session Attendees	# of Participant Packets Received
4/13/2026 – New Vista	79	61 (77%)
4/15/2026 – District Office	97	88 (91%)
4/16/2026 – Boulder HS	70	63 (90%)
4/18/2026 – District Office	40	35 (87%)
4/20/2026 – Broomfield HS	110	103 (94%)
4/22/2026 – Monarch HS	187	168 (90%)
4/23/2026 – <i>Follow up</i>	<i>N/A</i>	11
5/20/2026 - Columbine	60	39 (65%)
Totals	643	568 (88%)

BVSD held **seven** 2.5-hour community engagement sessions across the district, and a series of targeted follow-on sessions in different communities, throughout April of 2026. Most participants that submitted packets (**85%**) were Parents/Guardians of current BVSD students.

Region (Self-Identified)	# of Participant Packets Received
Boulder	196
Broomfield	95
Erie	10
Lafayette	23
Louisville	107
Louisville/Superior	6
Nederland	4
Superior	56
Other	6
(blank)	26

Challenge Prioritization Summary

Across all sessions, participants were asked to prioritize the challenges reflected across 12 experience cards reflecting the challenges faced in under-enrolled schools. 5 cards were consistent priorities (>50% of tables selected it)



Top 5 Cards

74%



CHALLENGE

#07

Limited Time for Small Group or Individualized Support

In under-enrolled schools, there is often not enough staffing available to create smaller, flexible student groups throughout the day. In these types of small group experiences, students typically receive dedicated support in core subjects like ELA and Math or have access to gifted & talented programming.



65%



CHALLENGE

#05

Mixed-Grade Classrooms

Under-enrolled schools may not have enough students for a full class at each grade level, requiring them to combine grade levels into one mixed-grade classroom (e.g., having students in 4th and 5th grade in one classroom with one teacher).



64%



CHALLENGE

#01

Limited Access to Specials

Under-enrolled schools may provide limited access to specials (art, music, PE) because they only have part-time staff to teach those courses. It is common for schools to share a specials teacher with another school and only have access to those classes for part of the week, month or year.



60%



CHALLENGE

#03

Part-time School Counselors

Under-enrolled schools may not be allocated a full-time counselor to work with their students, limiting the availability of counseling services throughout the week.



57%



CHALLENGE

#08

Part-time Instructional Support Staff

At under-enrolled schools, math and literacy specialists, teacher librarians, special education teachers, interventionists – who often provide support to students and teachers – are often not full-time positions and are shared with other schools.



Wildcards got used across tables, with some common themes

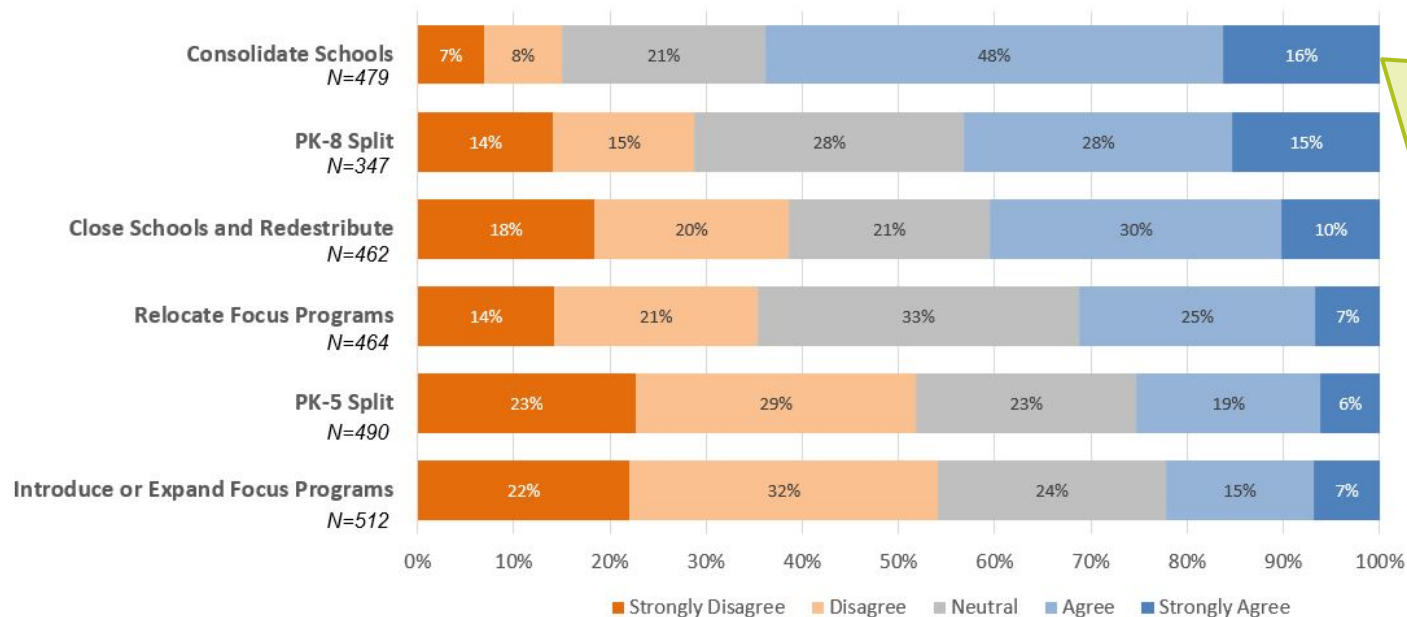
- **Maintaining Community Feel & Walkability of Neighborhood Schools (7)**
- **Protecting/Improving Special-Education Services (4)**
- **Advocating for state-level funding increases (3)**
- **Lowering class size caps (2)**
- **Preserving current focus programs (2)**

Other wildcards included: *Improving access/reliability of long-term substitutes, ensuring teacher job security through transitions, having dedicated literacy specialists, intentional design of multi-age classrooms, student and staff diversity, and access to specials/advanced learning for all students*

Consolidating schools was the shift with the most support – due to the sustainability of this option

"I believe this action is a move in the right direction to solve the challenges of under-enrolled schools"

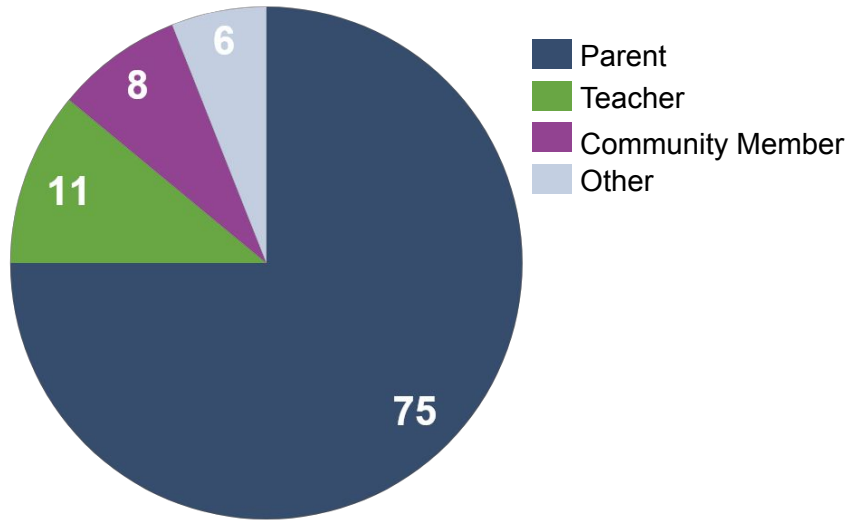
Participant Sentiment by Sustainable Shift *All Sessions*



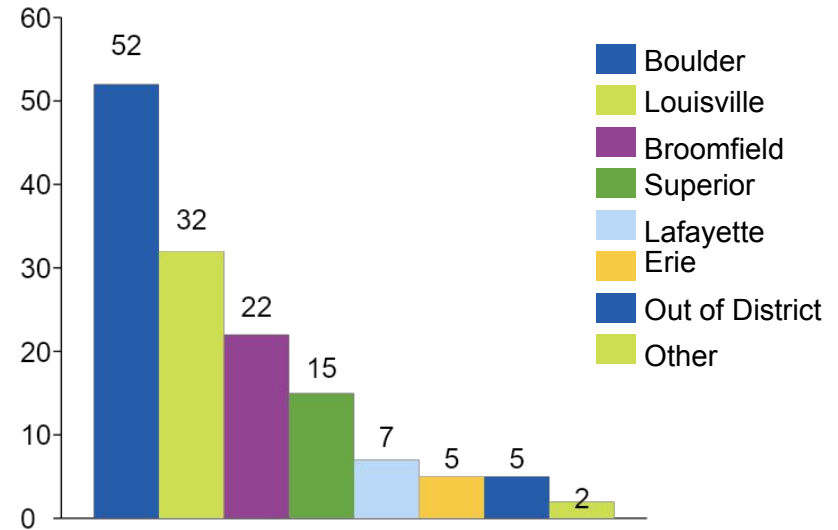
The primary **values** participants expressed that drove this rating were the **sustainability of this option** (most participants viewed this as a “long term solution” compared to, for example, expanding focus programs) and the opportunity to **build a new, unified school community**

Post-Session Community Survey

Respondent Identity

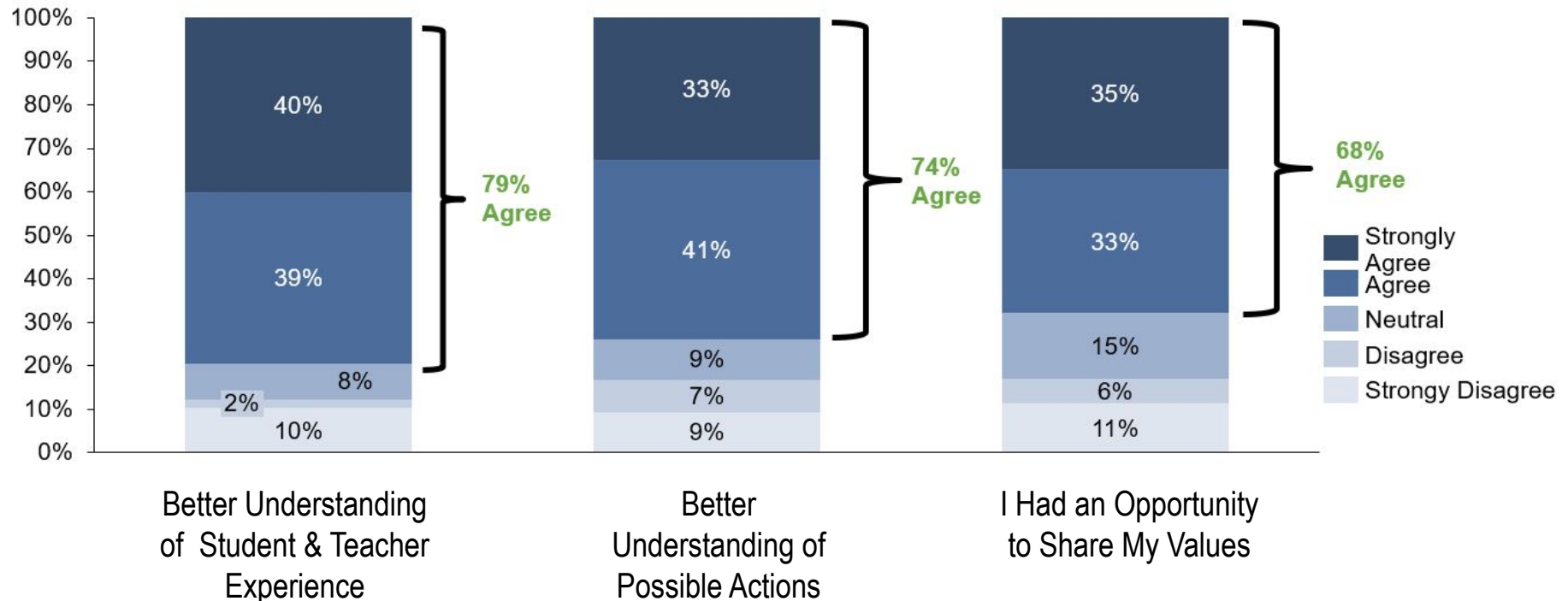


Respondent Region



Post-Session Community Survey

BVSD Post-Session Feedback Survey Results



BVSD Resilient Schools Survey: Overall Response Rates

Respondent Group	Surveys Completed	Total Invited	Response Rate
Parents/Guardians	2936	32966	8.9%
Staff	1700	6110	27.8%
Total	4636	39076	11.9%



Resilient Schools Survey: Representation by Group

Stakeholder Group	Total Respondents (n)	% of Total Sample
Parents Only	2799	53.4%
Staff Only	1141	21.8%
Staff & Parent (Overlap)	696	13.3%
Community Members	608	11.6%
Total	5244	100.0%



Resilient Schools Survey: Family Response Rate by Region

Region	Surveys Completed	Total Population	Response Rate
Louisville/Superior Neighborhood Schools	688	6332	10.9%
Boulder Neighborhood Schools	1239	12242	10.1%
Nederland Neighborhood Schools	50	623	8%
Broomfield Neighborhood Schools	258	3690	7%
Lafayette/Erie Neighborhood Schools	464	6776	6.8%
Other	237	8321	2.8%
Total	2936	12242	24%

Total valid Parent/Guardian Responses (excluding Staff-Parents/Guardians who only completed the Staff Survey) N = 2936



Resilient Schools Survey: Must-Have Items

Must-Have Item Selection Rates (All Groups Combined, n=5244)

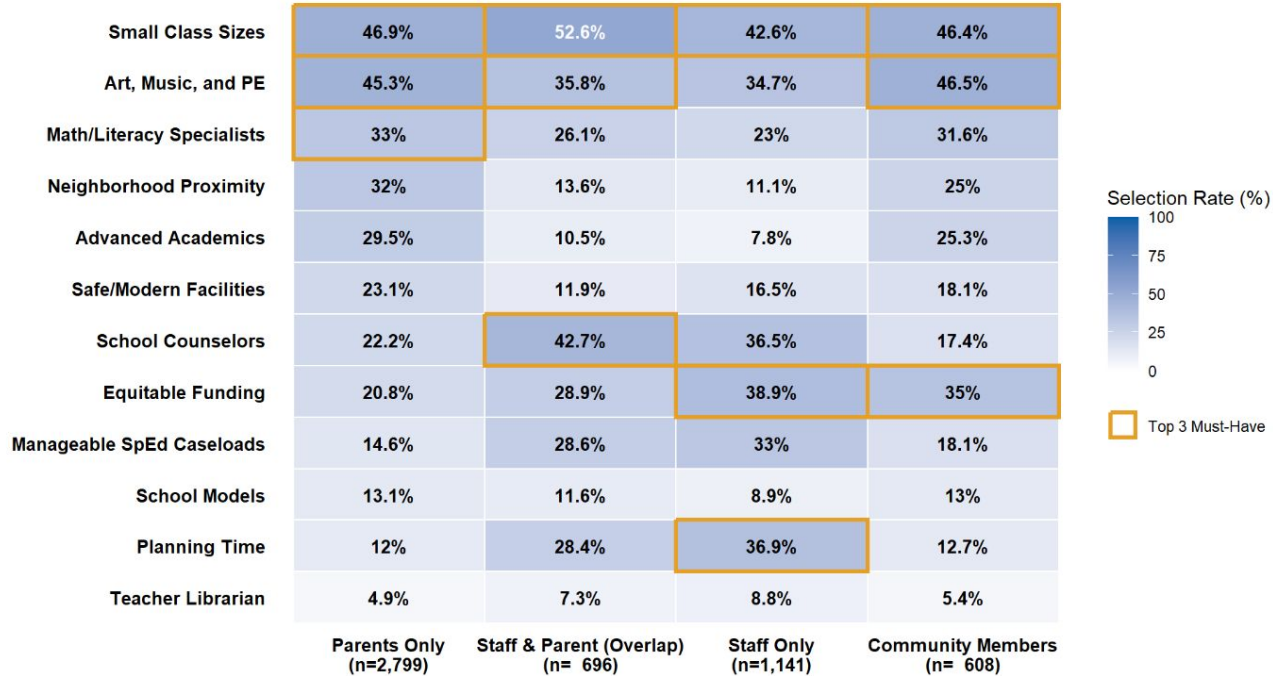
Item	Selection Rate
Small Class Sizes (K-5)	46.6%
Full-time Art, Music, and PE (At every school)	41.9%
Full-time Math and Literacy Specialists (At every school)	29.7%
Equitable Funding for All Schools (Directing resources where needs are highest)	27.5%
Full-time School Counselors (At every school)	27.5%
Neighborhood School Proximity (Walkable schools/short commute)	24.2%
Expanded Advanced Academic Programs (e.g., Gifted & Talented, accelerated math)	21.8%
Manageable Special Education Caseloads	20.9%
Teacher Planning and Collaboration Time	19.7%
Safe and Modern Facilities (Buildings and tech)	19.6%
Variety of School Models (Focus programs in addition to Neighborhood Schools)	12%
Full-time Teacher Librarian (On-site daily)	6.1%



Resilient Schools Survey: Must-Have Items by Group

Must-Have Item Selection Rates by Group

Comparing stakeholder priorities (Top 3 items per group outlined in gold)



Resilient Schools Survey: Must-Have Items by Region

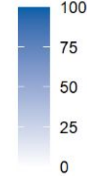
Parent/Guardian Must-Have Selection Rates by Region

Includes Parent and Staff-Parent respondents

Small Class Sizes	49.3%	43.6%	46.1%	51.4%	45.3%
Art, Music, and PE	42.4%	40.5%	46.1%	46.1%	50.9%
Math/Literacy Specialists	31.6%	36.8%	31.6%	31.8%	30.2%
Equitable Funding	19.7%	24%	29.8%	14.4%	43.4%
Advanced Academics	27.4%	23%	28.2%	27.7%	24.5%
Neighborhood Proximity	35.7%	25%	13.5%	41.8%	13.2%
School Counselors	23%	29.1%	25.8%	24.9%	20.8%
Safe/Modern Facilities	19.7%	23.6%	23.5%	19%	22.6%
Manageable SpEd Caseloads	14.2%	23%	23.1%	13.3%	24.5%
Planning Time	13.9%	15.5%	11.9%	12.9%	13.2%
School Models	15.8%	6.1%	12.3%	8.1%	9.4%
Teacher Librarian	5%	5.7%	6.2%	4.8%	1.9%

 Top 3 Regional Must-Have

Selection Rate (%)



Boulder Neighborhood Schools
(n=1,327)

Broomfield Neighborhood Schools
(n= 296)

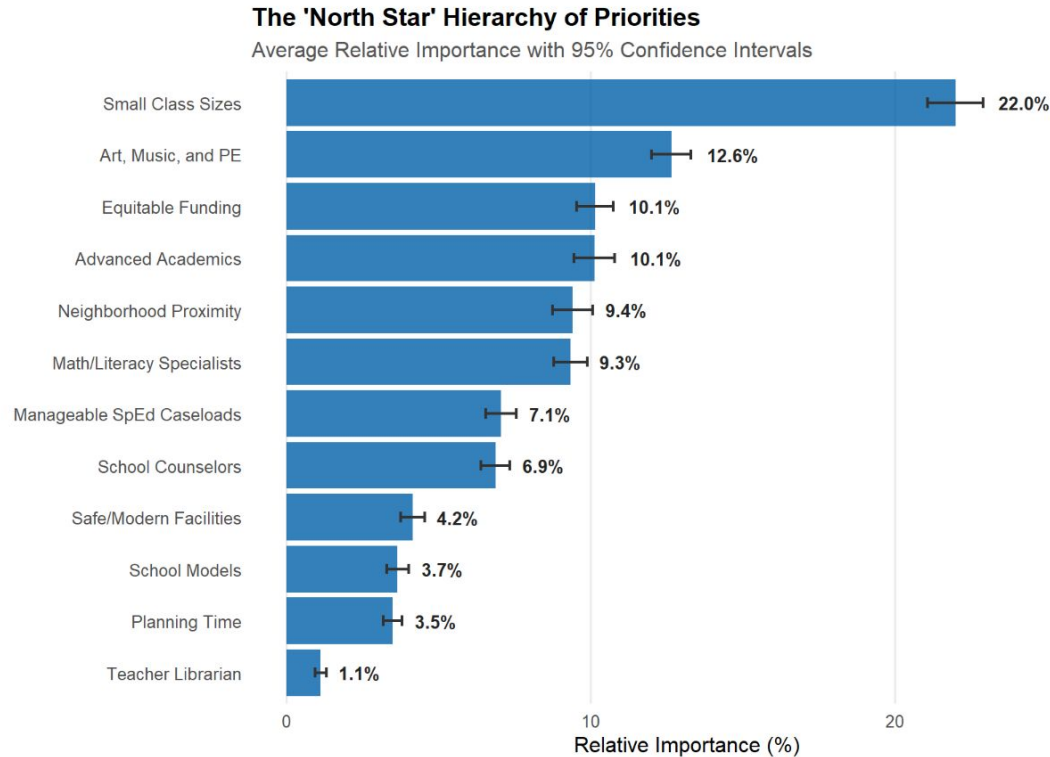
Lafayette/Erie Neighborhood Schools
(n= 503)

Louisville/Superior Neighborhood Schools
(n= 751)

Nederland Neighborhood Schools
(n= 53)



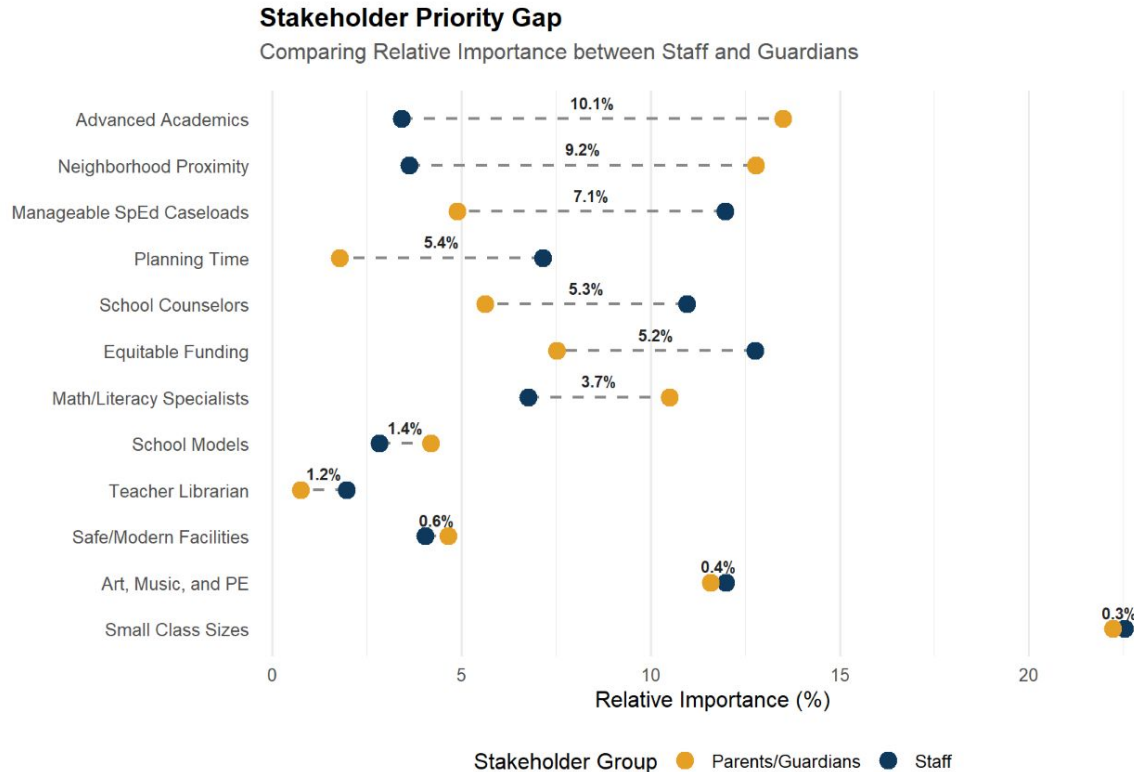
Resilient Schools Survey: Hierarchy of Priorities



- **The Top Mandate:** Keeping class sizes small is the highest priority, outranking every other by nearly two to one.
- **The Middle Tier:** Equitable funding and protecting well-rounded experiences—like art, music, and PE—form the second tier.
- **The Baseline Expectation:** Operational needs like teacher planning time and library staff rank lowest. The community views these as basic requirements the district should include generally, rather than items that should compete for extra resources.



Resilient Schools Survey: Stakeholder Priority Gap



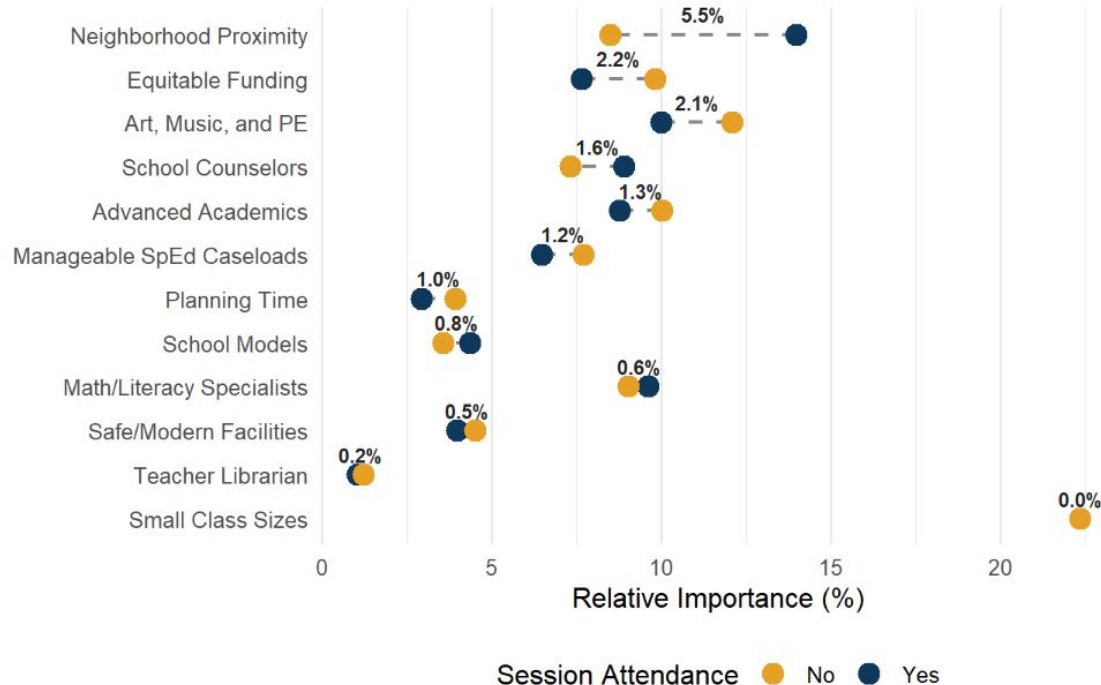
- **Alignment:** Families and staff agree on the absolute highest priority (small class sizes).
- **The Middle-Tier Split:** A sharp divide emerges in the middle, where priorities become highly polarizing between the two groups.
- **Family-Specific:** Families place more importance on advanced academics and having schools close to home.
- **Staff-Specific:** Staff heavily prioritize daily working and support conditions, like planning time, equitable funding, and manageable special education caseloads.



Resilient Schools Survey: Comparing Priorities

Engagement Session Attendees vs. Non-Attendees

Comparing relative importance of priorities



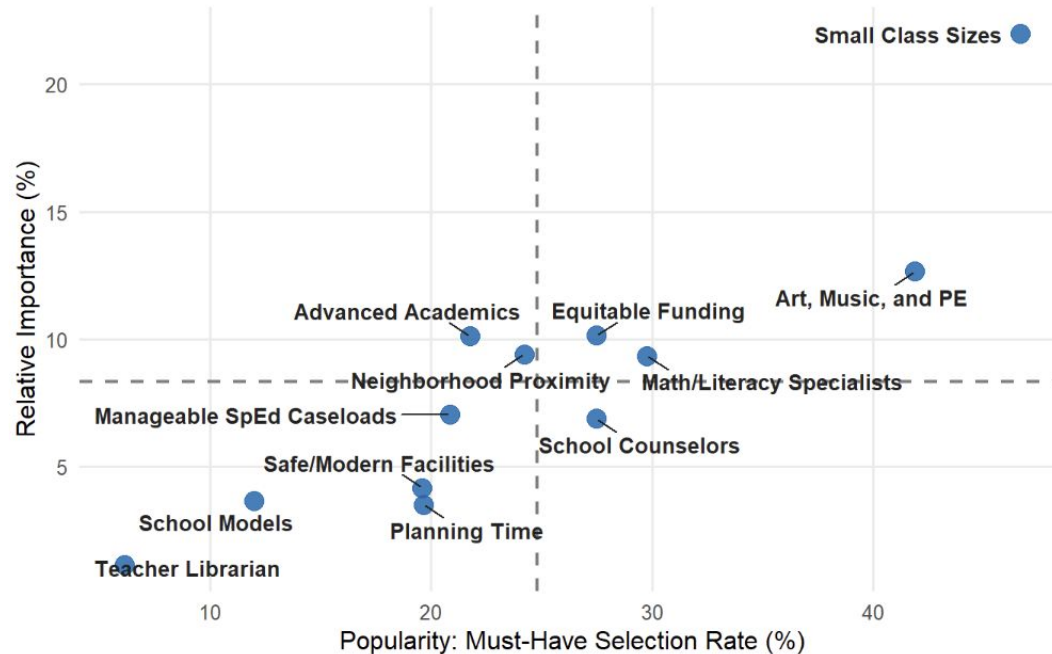
- **Alignment:** Relatively close alignment for most items between respondents who did and did not attend the community engagement sessions.
- **Divergence:** Engagement session attendees felt most differently from those who did not attend about neighborhood proximity of schools.



Resilient Schools Survey: Popularity vs. Importance

Popularity vs. Importance

Comparing Must-Have Selection Rates (Popularity) with Relative Importance



- **High-Consensus:** Keeping class sizes small and protecting art, music, and PE sit at the very top of relative importance and popularity.
- **Lower-Priority:** Options like school models, teacher planning time, and librarians are not seen as candidates for cuts; rather, the community views these as essential to keep running, but not where they want to direct new or limited resources.

